

Figure 3: C. Vijayaraghavachari

In drafting the Memorandum of Association and other documents required for registering the company, VOC took the help of one M.S. Thiruvariyan Pillai. Hailing from nearby Nagercoil in Travancore State, thirty-year-old Thiruvariyan Pillai was a correspondent for papers such as *Madras Mail*, *Pioneer*, *Times of India*, *Englishman* and *Empire*, and later the acting editor of the *West Coast Spectator*. Paid by the number of words he filed, he earned a tidy Rs 100 per month. Later, standing as defence witness in the sedition case against VOC, Thiruvariyan Pillai said, he met VOC often in connection with not only the drafting of the Memorandum and Articles of Association but also seeing it through the press. Paid Rs 10 per week for his efforts, he was employed in this task for six weeks. It appears that VOC also consulted him regarding the company's correspondence, especially in writing to foreign addressees.[38] Buying steamers was not a joke, and it was quite understandable that a modest pleader in far-off Tuticorin would be a little unsure of writing to shipbuilders and agents in Europe. VOC's letter to Vijayaraghavachari also indicates that the Memorandum and Articles of Association were drafted in a hurry and that the latter had suggested some revisions which VOC promised to carry out.[39]